

Star Ratings Strike Room — Centene Corporation

Motion: Star Ratings cliff-edge (new-logo) · **Product angle:** Queue Optimizer, with Back Office Optimizer for the operations-integration seats · **Built:** Jul 9 2026 · **Revised:** Jul 9 2026 after pre-mortem review · **Status:** send-ready draft, human approval gate not yet cleared

What changed in this version (from the first reviewed draft):

1. The Touch 4 email, which leaned on UnitedHealthcare's \$190M court figure, was cut across all five contacts and replaced with a second angle built on Centene's own closing measurement window. The court figure was working against the thesis (see the guardrail note below).
2. The four company-level threads (Taliaferro, Hoseini, Hedrick, Tran) were de-templated. They no longer share an identical body, figure, and CTA, so the sequence reads as five different notes rather than one blast to a committee that talks to itself.
3. A public, verifiable hook was added: Centene's own Stars trajectory, roughly 1% of members in 4-star-or-better plans in 2025 to near a fifth in 2026.
4. One precision fix: Wellcare by Fidelis Care is a full star under the 4.0 line at 3.0 overall, not a half star. The copy now names it as the largest single block and reserves the half-star framing for the contracts sitting right at 3.5, which is where the fastest bonus money is.
5. A hard contract count was removed from prospect copy pending the verification gate below.

Why Centene and not the marquee names: UnitedHealthcare, Humana, CVS/Aetna, Kaiser, Elevance, Molina, and Scan Health are on the current-customer exclusion list Naveen gave on Jul 8 and are held out of the new-logo motion. Centene is a confirmed non-customer ("a big one, we have to include them") and carries one of the largest eligible cliff-edge books in the universe: an overwhelmingly sub-4.0 Medicare book with a set of contracts sitting right at the bonus line.

Verification gate before send (one item)

Re-pull Centene's sub-4.0 contracts directly from the live CMS 2026 Star Ratings file and confirm two things: the count of contracts sitting at 3.5, a half star from the bonus, and that none of the near-the-line contracts has graduated to 4.0 since the seed was built. The prospect copy below deliberately avoids asserting a hard contract count for this reason. The only specific contract named in prospect copy is Wellcare by Fidelis Care, which is confirmed at 3.0 overall on the public 2026 release. Once the count is confirmed against the live file, it can be added back to the copy if you want the extra specificity.

Account snapshot

Centene's Medicare book runs largely under the Wellcare brand, and by public CMS 2026 data the majority of it sits below the 4.0 Quality Bonus Payment line: a portfolio average around 3.39 and roughly a fifth of members in 4-star-or-better plans. Centene has moved fast on this, from about 1% of members in 4-plus-star plans in 2025 to near 18 to 20% in 2026, with a Stars turnaround the CEO has put on the record. The part that is left is the expensive part: the contracts

sitting right at the 3.5 line, a half star from the bonus, where the fastest QBP recovery lives. The single largest sub-4.0 block is Wellcare by Fidelis Care, roughly 69,000 members at 3.0 overall, a bigger climb but the biggest single prize. Centene knows its exact picture better than we do.

Item	Value	Source
Forgone QBP across the sub-4.0 book	~\$76M (estimate)	Modeled from CMS 2026 ratings + enrollment
Contracts at the 3.5 cliff (half star from bonus)	modeled at 7 — confirm vs live file	CMS 2026 Star Ratings universe file
Largest single sub-4.0 block	Wellcare by Fidelis Care, ~69k members, 3.0 overall	Public CMS 2026 release
Public Stars trajectory	~1% (2025) to ~18–20% (2026) of members in 4+ plans	CMS 2026 release + Centene disclosures
Customer status	Confirmed NOT a customer, Wave 1 eligible	Naveen, Jul 8

Timing, why now: CMS released the 2026 ratings on Oct 8 2025, setting the PY2027 bonus. The measurement for the next ratings cycle is open across 2026 right now. The operational window to move a half star before the next cliff is this year, not next, and the fastest money is the contracts already sitting at 3.5.

Buying committee (real contacts, pulled and validated in Clay)

#	Name	Title	Tier	Email status	Angle
1	Corey Taliaferro	VP, Health Plan Operations (Carolina Complete Health)	A	Enriching (email drafted, fires on validation)	QO + BOO
2	Cyrus Hoseini	VP, Operations	B	Verified	QO + BOO
3	Justin Hedrick	VP, Operations and System Integration	B	Verified	QO + BOO
4	Matthew Tran	Sr Director, Member Experience and Innovation	B	Verified	QO
5	Jesse Lewis	Sr Director, Medicare Operations	B	Verified	QO + BOO

LinkedIn: Taliaferro /in/coreytaliaferromba/ · Hoseini /in/cyrus-hoseini-b739209/ · Hedrick /in/justin-hedrick-3bb08b6/ · Tran /in/matttran/ · Lewis /in/jesse-lewis-44445815a/

Emails: Hoseini cyrus.hoseini@centene.com · Hedrick justin.hedrick@centene.com · Tran matthew.tran@centene.com · Lewis jesse.lewis@centene.com · Taliaferro pending validation (Clay enriching)

Messaging level (a recommendation on your open question, Naveen): company-level narrative for the enterprise ops seats (Hoseini, Hedrick, Taliaferro, Tran), contract-specific only where a leader clearly owns the Medicare book. Jesse

Lewis, Sr Director of Medicare Operations, is the one seat where naming the Wellcare cliff directly is defensible. Everyone else hears the enterprise version so we do not overclaim knowledge of who owns which contract.

Verified-claims guardrail (what this copy is allowed to say)

Cleared for prospect copy: Centene's own forgone-QBP exposure, always labeled an estimate from public CMS data with the humility clause; Centene's public Stars trajectory (roughly 1% to near a fifth of members in 4-star-or-better plans, 2025 to 2026) from CMS releases and Centene's own disclosures; the largest single sub-4.0 block, Wellcare by Fidelis Care at roughly 69,000 members and 3.0 overall, from the public CMS 2026 release; and what Intradiem is, Dynamic Workforce Orchestration across the contact center and the back office.

Removed from this version: the UnitedHealthcare \$190M court figure. It was cut because the case it comes from is one UnitedHealthcare won by arguing the measure was applied unfairly. To a Medicare-quality leader that reads as evidence the measure is arbitrary and litigable, not as proof that operational execution moves the rating, and the copy also had to disclose the measure is being retired, which undercut its own proof point.

Not used anywhere below: any Intradiem ROI, lift, or customer-outcome number, because none is verified in the Value Repository yet. The copy carries weight from the prospect's own math and their own public record, not from claims we cannot source.

Cadence and committee choreography

Every contact runs the same five-touch, multi-channel cadence across business days:

- **Touch 1 (Day 1):** Email 1
- **Touch 2 (Day 2):** LinkedIn connection request
- **Touch 3 (Day 4):** Voicemail, plus a LinkedIn message the same day
- **Touch 4 (Day 6):** Email 2 (second angle, the closing measurement window)
- **Touch 5 (Day 9):** Breakup email

Entry is staggered so a consistent half-star narrative surfaces inside Centene ops within one week without looking like a blast: Hoseini, Hedrick, and Taliaferro enter on Day 1; Lewis and Tran enter one day behind them. The bodies are now distinct per contact, so if two of these leaders compare notes they see five different angles on the same problem rather than one template. Taliaferro's Email 1 is drafted and queued; it fires the moment Clay validates his address, and his LinkedIn connection carries the opening in the meantime so his thread does not go cold.

Sequences

1. Corey Taliaferro — VP, Health Plan Operations (Tier A) • QO + BOO

Touch 1 (Day 1) — Email (*queued, fires on address validation*) Subject: the half star lives on the floor

Corey, the money sitting between Centene's near-the-line contracts and the 4.0 bonus is not a scorecard problem. It is decided on the operations floor you run, in the weeks volume runs hardest and service either holds or slips right when the

measures are watching. Across the sub-4.0 book that gap models to roughly \$76M in forgone Quality Bonus Payments from public CMS data, and you will have the exact figure for the plans you own.

Intradiem runs workforce orchestration across the contact center and the back office, acting on real-time conditions so quality does not dip under load. Worth twenty minutes on where your book looks most exposed heading into the next cycle?

Dallas

Touch 2 (Day 2) — LinkedIn connection request Corey, I work the operations side of health plan Stars, specifically the gap between what the scorecard measures and what actually happens on the floor when volume spikes. Would value connecting.

Touch 3 (Day 4) — Voicemail Corey, this is Dallas Andrews at Intradiem. I sent a note on the half star between Centene's near-the-line contracts and the 4.0 bonus, and why so much of it comes down to how operations hold up during peak weeks. That is the piece we work on. If it is worth a short conversation I am at [number], or a reply to the email works. Thanks Corey.

Touch 3 (Day 4) — LinkedIn message Corey, left you a voicemail as well. Short version: the fastest Star money for Centene is the contracts right at the line, and whether they clear is largely an execution question during peak weeks. That is where Intradiem sits. Open to twenty minutes on where it is tightest for your book?

Touch 4 (Day 6) — Email Subject: the window is more than half gone

Corey, the reason this is a now problem and not an October problem: the measurement that sets the next rating is happening across this year, and it is already more than half spent. Every peak week that passes without the operational piece in place locks in more of the next cliff before the ratings are ever published. The contracts closest to 4.0 are the ones where that math still swings your way if the execution holds.

That is exactly what Intradiem is built to make consistent under load. If it is useful, I can walk how the orchestration piece fits an operation your size in about twenty minutes.

Dallas

Touch 5 (Day 9) — Email Subject: leaving it here

Corey, I will stop here so I am not cluttering your inbox. If protecting the near-the-line contracts before the cycle closes lands on your desk, the workforce-execution angle is where I would start, and I am glad to help think it through whenever the timing is right.

Dallas

2. Cyrus Hoseini — VP, Operations (Tier B) · QO + BOO

Touch 1 (Day 1) — Email Subject: the last stretch of the Stars climb

Cyrus, Centene has already done the hard early part of the Stars climb, from roughly 1% of members in 4-star plans last year to near a fifth this year. The part that is left is the expensive part: the contracts sitting right at the line where a half star still separates them from the 4.0 bonus. By our estimate from public CMS data that gap is worth about \$76M in forgone Quality Bonus Payments across the sub-4.0 book, and you will know the real number.

Most of that half star is an execution question, whether service levels and back-office turnaround hold during the weeks volume runs hardest, not something a scorecard fixes after the fact. Intradiem runs workforce orchestration across the

contact center and the back office, acting on real-time conditions so quality does not slip under load. Worth twenty minutes on where the next cycle looks most exposed?

Dallas

Touch 2 (Day 2) — LinkedIn connection request Cyrus, reached out on the operational side of the last stretch of Centene's Stars climb. Would value connecting here too.

Touch 3 (Day 4) — Voicemail Cyrus, this is Dallas Andrews with Intradiem. I emailed you about the last stretch of the Stars climb, the near-the-line contracts where a half star still stands between them and the bonus, and how much of that rides on service levels holding during peak weeks. That is the seam we work. If it is worth twenty minutes I am at [number]. Thanks Cyrus.

Touch 3 (Day 4) — LinkedIn message Cyrus, left a short voicemail too. The heart of it: the contracts closest to 4.0 are an execution question more than a scorecard one, and that is where Intradiem sits. Worth a quick call on where it is tightest across the book?

Touch 4 (Day 6) — Email Subject: where the next half point comes from

Cyrus, the first eighteen points came from the work Centene has already done. The next ones are harder, because the contracts still under the line are the ones where the gap opens under load: real-time conditions change, the workforce response lags, and the measures catch it. The measurement window for the next rating is running now, so that lag is being priced into the next cliff week by week.

Intradiem closes that lag automatically, which is what keeps the climb going instead of stalling at the expensive part. Twenty minutes to walk how it fits an operation your size?

Dallas

Touch 5 (Day 9) — Email Subject: last note

Cyrus, I will leave it here. If finishing the Stars climb on the near-the-line contracts becomes a priority before the cycle closes, the workforce-execution angle is where I would start, and I am glad to help whenever the timing is right.

Dallas

3. Justin Hedrick — VP, Operations and System Integration (Tier B) • QO + BOO

Touch 1 (Day 1) — Email Subject: where the half star actually moves

Justin, given the systems-integration side of your role you will read this the way I mean it. The half star between Centene's near-the-line contracts and the 4.0 bonus tends to live in the gaps between systems and staffing: conditions change in real time, the workforce response lags, and service quality dips right when it counts toward the rating. Across the sub-4.0 book that gap models to about \$76M in forgone Quality Bonus Payments from public CMS data, and your read on the exact number beats mine.

Intradiem sits in that gap, orchestrating the contact center and the back office off live signals instead of after the report. Twenty minutes to compare notes on where the integration and execution seams are widest?

Dallas

Touch 2 (Day 2) — LinkedIn connection request Justin, reached out on the operational side of Centene's Star cliff, specifically the systems-and-staffing gap where the near-the-line contracts are won or lost. Would value connecting.

Touch 3 (Day 4) — Voicemail Justin, this is Dallas Andrews at Intradiem. I sent a note on the half star across Centene's near-the-line contracts and how much of it opens up in the gaps between systems and staffing during peak weeks. That is the part we automate. If it is worth a short conversation I am at [number]. Thanks Justin.

Touch 3 (Day 4) — LinkedIn message Justin, left you a voicemail as well. Short version: the half star on the near-the-line contracts lives in the lag between real-time conditions and the workforce response, and closing that lag is what Intradiem does. Happy to show the integration view specifically. Worth twenty minutes?

Touch 4 (Day 6) — Email Subject: the lag is being priced in now

Justin, one point that makes this a this-year question. The measurement that sets the next rating is running across 2026 right now, which means every week the systems-to-staffing lag goes unclosed is a week that gets baked into the next cliff before the ratings publish. The near-the-line contracts are where that still swings your way if the response keeps pace with conditions.

Intradiem automates that response off live signals, so the leverage works for you instead of against you. Happy to show the integration view specifically if that is the part you would want to pressure-test, about twenty minutes.

Dallas

Touch 5 (Day 9) — Email Subject: closing the loop

Justin, I will stop here. If the near-the-line exposure surfaces as an operations-and-systems priority this year, that is squarely where I spend my time, and I am glad to pick it back up whenever it is worth your while.

Dallas

4. Matthew Tran — Sr Director, Member Experience and Innovation (Tier B) · QO

Touch 1 (Day 1) — Email Subject: member experience and the half star

Matthew, the measures that decide a half star, the ones tied to how members experience service, sit closest to your work. Across Centene's sub-4.0 book the gap to the 4.0 bonus models to roughly \$76M in forgone Quality Bonus Payments by our estimate from public CMS data, and the contracts closest to the line are where it is most recoverable. You will have the precise view.

The experience gap usually opens under load: hold times climb, follow-ups slip, and the member feels it in exactly the interactions the rating measures. Intradiem orchestrates the workforce in real time so the experience holds when volume does not cooperate. Worth twenty minutes on where member experience is most exposed heading into the next cycle?

Dallas

Touch 2 (Day 2) — LinkedIn connection request Matthew, sent a note on the member-experience side of Centene's Star cliff, the measures that tend to slip first under load. Would value being connected.

Touch 3 (Day 4) — Voicemail Matthew, this is Dallas Andrews with Intradiem. I emailed you about the member-experience measures inside Centene's half-star gap and how they slip under load, exactly when the rating is watching. That is what we help hold steady. If it is worth twenty minutes I am at [number]. Thanks Matthew.

Touch 3 (Day 4) — LinkedIn message Matthew, left a quick voicemail too. The gist: the experience-linked measures are where the half star is won, and they are the first thing to slip when volume spikes. Intradiem keeps them steady under load. Open to a short call on where it is tightest for you?

Touch 4 (Day 6) — Email Subject: the measures are being scored right now

Matthew, the reason this is worth a look now rather than in October: the experience-linked measures that set the next rating are being scored across this year, in the live interactions happening today, not on release day. Every stretch where the experience slips under load is a stretch that counts toward the next cliff before anyone sees the number. The contracts closest to 4.0 are where holding the experience steady still moves the rating.

That real-time hold is exactly what Intradiem is built for. If it helps, I can show how the orchestration piece protects the experience measures specifically, in about twenty minutes.

Dallas

Touch 5 (Day 9) — Email Subject: last one

Matthew, I will leave it here. If the experience-linked measures become a focus before the cycle closes, that is exactly the seam I work, and I am happy to help whenever the timing fits.

Dallas

5. Jesse Lewis — Sr Director, Medicare Operations (Tier B) · QO + BOO — the one seat cleared for contract-specific messaging

Touch 1 (Day 1) — Email Subject: the Wellcare contracts closest to 4.0

Jesse, since you own Medicare operations I will be specific. By our estimate from public CMS data, the Wellcare book carries roughly \$76M in forgone Quality Bonus Payments across its sub-4.0 contracts. The fastest of that to recover is the set sitting right at 3.5, a half star from the bonus. The largest single block is Wellcare by Fidelis Care, around 69,000 members at 3.0 overall, a bigger climb but the biggest prize. You will know the exact picture.

On the contracts closest to the line, the gap is largely an execution question: whether service and back-office turnaround hold during peak weeks. Intradiem orchestrates the contact center and the back office off real-time conditions so they do. Twenty minutes on the Wellcare contracts nearest the line?

Dallas

Touch 2 (Day 2) — LinkedIn connection request Jesse, reached out on the Wellcare contracts closest to the 4.0 line. Would value connecting here too.

Touch 3 (Day 4) — Voicemail Jesse, this is Dallas Andrews at Intradiem. I sent a note on the Wellcare contracts sitting closest to the 4.0 line, the 3.5 set that is the fastest bonus money, plus Fidelis as the largest block, and how much of it comes down to execution holding during peak weeks. That is what we work on. Worth a short call? I am at [number]. Thanks Jesse.

Touch 3 (Day 4) — LinkedIn message Jesse, left you a voicemail as well. Short version: the half star on the Wellcare contracts nearest 4.0 is an execution question, and closing that gap in real time is what Intradiem does. Open to twenty minutes on the ones nearest the line?

Touch 4 (Day 6) — Email Subject: the next rating is being set now

Jesse, one point on timing that matters for the Medicare book specifically. The measurement that sets the next rating is running across this year, so the Wellcare contracts nearest 4.0 are being decided right now, in the peak weeks happening between now and year end, not on the October release. Every one of those weeks where execution holds is a week that counts toward clearing the line; every one where it slips is priced into the next cliff.

Intradiem is built to make that execution consistent under load. If useful, I can walk the Medicare-operations view of it in about twenty minutes.

Dallas

Touch 5 (Day 9) — Email Subject: leaving it here

Jesse, I will stop for now. If protecting the half star on the Wellcare contracts before the next cycle becomes a priority, the workforce-execution angle is where I would start, and I am glad to help think it through whenever the timing is right.

Dallas

Objection quick-handles

"We already have WFM." Right, and WFM tells you what should happen with staffing. This is about what happens in the moment conditions change, the automated response between forecast and floor. It sits alongside WFM, it does not replace it.

"We are already improving our Stars." You are, and the public numbers show it, from about 1% of members in 4-star plans to near a fifth in a year. The contracts still under the line are the expensive part of that climb, where the gap opens under load and a scorecard cannot close it after the fact. That is the piece we would help hold, so the progress does not stall at the hardest contracts.

"Wait for the October ratings." The ratings in October report a measurement window that is closing now. Waiting means the next cliff is already set before anyone acts. The half star moves during the year, not on release day.

"Send me information." Happy to. The one thing a deck will not answer is which of your contracts are closest to the line and most execution-sensitive, which is a twenty-minute conversation. I will send the overview and we can find time if it is worth it.

Footer: modeled vs verified

Every dollar figure here is an estimate modeled from public CMS 2026 data and labeled as such, with the humility clause that Centene knows its exact picture better than we do. Centene's Stars trajectory and the Wellcare by Fidelis Care figure are from public CMS releases and Centene's own disclosures. No Intradiem ROI, lift, or customer-outcome claim appears anywhere in this copy because none is verified in the Value Repository yet. The prior version's UnitedHealthcare \$190M court figure has been removed. Nothing here has cleared the human approval gate; this is a send-ready draft for review.